Track 9D

2026-10-23

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Track 9D — Mathematical Formalization: Formalization & Theorem Derivation



Figure 1: Track 9D Mathematical Formalization — Plan Overview Infographic

Purpose

Express the Phase 8 structural themes in mathematical notation, eliminating the ambiguity of natural language. Successful formalization enables deductive theorem derivation and generation of counterintuitive predictions. This is the most ambitious track, but its potential impact is the greatest.

Why Formalize?

- Natural language descriptions like "Edge Typology" leave too much room for interpretation. Mathematical definitions eliminate ambiguity
- Formalization enables deduction — deriving theorems and predictions
- Mathematical representation reveals relationships between themes, potentially uncovering a unifying structure across all five

Candidate Frameworks

Mathematical Tool	Target Theme	Expected Outcome
Category Theory	Integration of all 5 themes	Formalize inter-theme relationships as morphisms
Graph Theory	Edge Typology	Represent boundary connection patterns as adjacency matrices

Mathematical Tool	Target Theme	Expected Outcome
Topological Spaces	Field Multi-Layering	Define essential "field" structure via topological invariants
Dynamical Systems	Bundle-to-Field Recirculation	Express circulation as attractors and limit cycles
Fractal Geometry	Cross-Scale Self-Similarity	Quantify self-similar dimensions
Lattice Theory	Bundle Polymorphism	Formalize bundles as partially ordered structures

Methodology

Step 1: Natural Language Analysis

Decompose theme claims into components: subject (what is being described), property (what is being claimed), relation (connections to other concepts), and quantification (universal or existential scope).

Step 2: Framework Selection

Choose the mathematical framework that most naturally fits the decomposed structure. When multiple candidates exist, start with the simplest.

Step 3: Definition Attempt

Define key concepts within the chosen framework. Validate definitions against known cases.

Step 4: Theorem and Prediction Derivation

Derive properties that follow from the definitions. Check for non-trivial consequences and counterintuitive predictions.

Step 5: Verification

Confirm that derived properties are consistent with existing data from the 30 domains. If contradictions arise, revise definitions. If predictions emerge, add them to Track 9C's verification queue.

Important Notes

- **Avoid forced formalization**: A mathematically elegant definition that distorts the original insight has no value
- **Failed formalization is also a result**: The finding "this concept cannot be captured within framework X" is itself valuable knowledge

Dependencies

If Track 9A (Grounding) and Track 9B (Falsification) revise claims, the revised versions become formalization targets.

Deliverables

- **Component decomposition** — Natural language claims broken into elements
- **Mathematical definitions** — Formal definitions within chosen frameworks
- **Derived theorems** — Non-trivial properties derived from definitions
- **Prediction list** — Testable predictions generated through formalization
- **Limitation record** — Concepts that resisted formalization and why

Convergence Criteria

- At least one theme has completed the definition-theorem-verification cycle
- If formalization is judged impossible, the reasons are documented
- Some insight into a unifying structure across all five themes has been obtained